



PROTOTYPE REVIEW & PRODUCT VALIDATION GUIDE

From interactive concept to production marketplace

Project	Veritas Commerce Marketplace
Document purpose	Client review, scope validation and final-product alignment
Prototype access	Vercel deployment link to be shared with this document

This document should be reviewed together with the interactive prototype.

Document Purpose

The prototype is the visual and interaction blueprint for Veritas Commerce Marketplace. It is designed to let stakeholders review the proposed customer experience, seller workflow, administrative controls, responsive behavior and design language before full development begins.

The key principle

Prototype approval is a product decision, not merely a design approval. Once the main journeys, information structure, role boundaries and business rules are agreed, development can move forward with much less rework.

What this guide helps the client do

- Understand what each prototype page represents and why it exists.
- Review the three marketplace roles: customer, seller and platform administrator.
- Follow the most important end-to-end business journeys before code is built.
- Identify which parts are interactive demonstrations and which require real backend development.
- Confirm the decisions that should be frozen before the production build starts.
- Understand how the prototype will be translated into a secure, database-backed, deployable marketplace.

Recommended reading order

1. Open the prototype Overview page and use the top Prototype Navigation bar.
2. Review the Customer Storefront from discovery through checkout and order tracking.
3. Review the Seller Portal from application through product, order and payout management.
4. Review the Admin Portal for marketplace governance, approval, commission and payout control.
5. Check Responsive and Design System pages to verify consistency across devices and components.
6. Use the approval checklist in this document to record final decisions before development.

What the prototype represents

Veritas Commerce Marketplace is modeled as one marketplace product serving three different user groups. The prototype intentionally connects those views so the client can evaluate the complete operating model rather than isolated screens.

Area	Primary user	Purpose
Customer Storefront	Shoppers / buyers	Discover products and stores, purchase items, manage an account and track orders.
Seller Portal	Approved marketplace sellers	Create and manage a store, publish products, control inventory, process orders and monitor earnings.
Admin Portal	Veritas platform team	Control seller access, marketplace content, orders, commission, payouts and operational settings.

What the prototype validates

- Information architecture: what users can find and where.
- User journeys: the order in which key tasks happen.
- Role separation: what customers, sellers and administrators are allowed to see and do.
- Business workflow: how seller approval, product publishing, orders, commission and payouts connect.
- Responsive behavior: how dense dashboards and customer pages adapt from desktop to mobile.
- Design consistency: typography, color, buttons, forms, cards, tables, statuses and feedback patterns.
- Development scope: a visual reference that reduces ambiguity when engineering begins.

What it does not prove yet

The prototype does not prove production security, database integrity, real payment settlement, email delivery, server performance, live inventory synchronization or real role permissions. Those are implementation responsibilities for the final product.

Prototype package and navigation

Every prototype page is now connected through a common internal navigation header.

Prototype page	What to review	Final-product meaning
Overview	Product map, journeys and major decisions	Entry point and scope summary
Customer Storefront	Browsing, product detail, cart, checkout, account and tracking	Public marketplace + buyer account
Seller Portal	Seller application, store setup, products, stock, orders and payouts	Seller self-service workspace
Admin Portal	Approvals, monitoring, financial controls and settings	Marketplace operations control center
Responsive	Mobile/tablet/desktop adaptations	Production responsiveness requirements
Design System	Reusable visual components and status patterns	Shared implementation language for frontend development
Consistency Review	Cross-role component checks and handoff notes	Quality-control reference for implementation

How to use the internal header

From any prototype page, the reviewer can switch directly to the other prototype areas without returning to the Overview. The active page is highlighted. On narrow screens, the navigation can scroll horizontally so the review structure remains available without altering the underlying page layouts.

Suggested client-review behavior

- Review the flow, labels, actions and data shown on each screen rather than focusing only on visual styling.
- Use realistic scenarios: a new customer placing an order, a new seller joining, and an admin resolving marketplace operations.
- Record missing business rules separately from cosmetic preferences.
- Treat any new module not represented in the prototype as a scope addition unless it is already included in the approved development scope.

Customer storefront

The customer side demonstrates how a shopper discovers, evaluates, purchases and tracks marketplace products.

Primary use cases

Use case	Prototype behavior	Production requirement
Discover products	Home, featured areas, store discovery, listings and search/filter patterns	Database-backed catalogue, categories, search and availability
Evaluate a product	Images, description, specifications, seller context, price and stock state	Real product data, variants, inventory and media storage
Build a cart	Cart presentation and order summary	Persistent cart, quantity validation and recalculation
Checkout	Contact, shipping and payment sequence	Validated addresses, real payment provider, taxes/shipping rules where applicable
Manage account	Sign in, registration, password and profile patterns	Secure authentication, password hashing, sessions and permissions
Track orders	Order detail, items and status history	Live order state, seller updates, tracking data and notifications

Customer journey to validate

Journey

Browse/search → product detail → add to cart → checkout → payment → confirmation → account/order history → tracking.

Questions the client should answer

- Does the customer see enough information to confidently purchase a product?
- Are the categories, filters and product attributes appropriate for the types of products expected at launch?
- Is guest checkout required, or should checkout require an account?
- What shipping options, regions and address rules are required in Phase 1?
- Which payment methods must be available at launch?
- Which order statuses should customers see, and which should remain internal?
- Are returns/refunds handled by the seller, by Veritas, or through a mixed policy?

Seller portal

The seller portal demonstrates the operating workflow of a marketplace seller from application through payout.

Seller lifecycle represented by the prototype

Seller lifecycle

Apply to sell → admin decision → store setup → product creation → stock management → receive orders → ship orders → review earnings → request payout.

Module	Purpose in prototype	What becomes real in production
Seller application	Captures business/contact/catalogue information and approval states	Stored application records, validation, admin review and notifications
Store identity	Shows branding, business information and policies	Public seller profile linked to seller account
Product management	Shows product details, images, pricing, variants and states	CRUD operations, validation, category linkage and media uploads
Inventory	Shows stock counts and movement history	Transactional stock updates and auditable adjustment records
Orders	Shows seller-specific orders and fulfillment workflow	Role-scoped data, status transitions and tracking updates
Earnings	Shows commission, balances and statements	Immutable financial ledger and order-level earning calculations
Payouts	Shows payout request/history workflow	Admin-reviewed requests and settlement records

Seller-side decisions to confirm

- What information is mandatory before a seller can be approved?
- Does every product require admin approval, or only certain categories/sellers?
- Can sellers set their own shipping and return policies?
- Can a seller create variants such as size and color in Phase 1?
- How should stock behave when an order is cancelled or refunded?
- When does seller earning become available: after payment, shipment, delivery, or a hold period?
- Will payouts be manually approved in Phase 1 or automatically settled by a payment provider?

Admin portal

The admin portal is the control layer for operating the marketplace, managing risk and enforcing business rules.

Core administrative use cases

Control area	Admin responsibility
Seller governance	Approve, reject, suspend or reactivate seller access and review seller information.
Catalogue governance	Review/manage marketplace products, categories and brands according to policy.
Order oversight	View marketplace-wide order activity, statuses and operational exceptions.
Commission	Set and manage the marketplace commission policy used to calculate platform revenue and seller earnings.
Payments/refunds	Review payment state, refunds and financial exceptions.
Seller earnings	See seller balances, commission deductions and payout requests.
Payout review	Approve/reject payout requests and maintain settlement history.
Platform settings	Maintain company information, operational settings and notification preferences.
Roles and team	Restrict administrative access according to staff responsibility.

Why this matters before development

The admin area determines how much of the marketplace can operate without developer intervention. The production objective should be that routine seller approvals, product control, order supervision, commission updates and payout actions can be completed from the admin interface rather than by manually editing database records.

Client approval focus

Confirm which controls belong to the platform team, which can be delegated to sellers, and which actions require an audit trail or a second approval.

End-to-end marketplace use cases

The value of the prototype is strongest when the three areas are reviewed as one connected system.

Use Case A — Seller joins and becomes active

7. Seller submits an application.
8. Admin reviews the application.
9. If approved, the seller gains access to store-management functions.
10. Seller adds store identity, business details and policies.
11. Store becomes visible to customers according to the marketplace approval rules.

Use Case B — Product becomes available for sale

12. Seller creates a product with images, price, category, SKU and stock.
13. The product is saved as draft or submitted/published according to the approval policy.
14. If moderation is required, admin reviews the product.
15. Published product becomes discoverable through the storefront and seller store.
16. Stock state shown to the customer reflects the production inventory record.

Use Case C — Customer places an order

17. Customer adds an available product to cart and starts checkout.
18. System validates price, stock and order totals before payment.
19. Payment succeeds or fails; the final product must record the outcome.
20. On successful payment, an order is created with a snapshot of the commercial values used at checkout.
21. The correct seller receives the order while the admin can see the marketplace-wide transaction.
22. Stock is reduced and the customer receives confirmation.

Use Case D — Seller fulfills the order

23. Seller opens the order in the seller portal.
24. Seller progresses the order through the approved fulfillment statuses.
25. Carrier/tracking information can be attached where applicable.
26. Customer sees the corresponding external status and tracking information.
27. Admin retains marketplace-level visibility for support or dispute handling.

Use Case E — Commission and payout

28. The order keeps the commission rate applicable to that transaction.
29. Platform commission and seller earning are calculated and recorded independently.
30. Seller sees the earning in their statement according to the settlement rule.
31. Seller submits a payout request when eligible.
32. Admin reviews the request and the resulting payout becomes part of the permanent financial history.

Business rules the prototype is helping to freeze

Business rule	Why it must be confirmed before development
Seller approval	Defines onboarding states, access control and notification logic.
Product moderation	Determines whether publishing is instant or requires an admin workflow.
Commission model	Affects order totals, seller statements, platform revenue and payout calculations.
Inventory behavior	Controls overselling, cancellation restoration and variant stock.
Order status model	Defines valid transitions and what the customer/seller/admin can see.
Refund/cancellation policy	Affects payment reversal, stock restoration and seller earnings.
Payout eligibility	Defines when seller money becomes available and what admin can approve.
Role permissions	Prevents one seller accessing another seller's data and separates administrative responsibilities.
Notification events	Defines which user actions trigger email or other notifications.

Important production data principle

Do not rewrite financial history

Order prices, commission values, seller earnings, payment attempts, stock movements, order-status changes and payout records should be preserved as historical records. Changing a product price or commission rate later must not silently change old transactions.

Design system and responsive behavior

The Design System and Responsive pages are not decorative extras. They are implementation references intended to keep the final product consistent as the number of screens grows.

Design system use case

- Defines a shared visual language for buttons, forms, cards, tables, status badges, overlays and navigation.
- Reduces one-off UI decisions during development.
- Makes customer, seller and admin interfaces feel like parts of the same product.
- Creates reusable frontend components, improving delivery speed and maintenance.
- Provides a consistent basis for future modules added after Phase 1.

Responsive page use case

- Shows how customer browsing and checkout adapt on smaller devices.
- Shows how seller/admin tables become more usable cards or condensed layouts where appropriate.
- Establishes which information must remain visible on mobile and which can be progressively disclosed.
- Provides an explicit reference for testing desktop, tablet and mobile behavior during implementation.

Prototype versus final product

The prototype shows intended behavior; production development supplies the real system behind it.

Area	Prototype	Final product
Navigation	Static/internal prototype links	Application routes with authentication and authorization
Data	Demo/sample content	Database-backed customer, seller, product, order and financial records
Forms	UI states and simulated interactions	Validation, secure submission, persistence and error handling
Authentication	Demonstrated screens	Real accounts, password security, sessions and role permissions
Search & filters	UI behavior	Queries over live catalogue data
Cart	Demonstrated flow	Persistent cart with stock/price validation
Checkout	Prototype payment step	Payment provider integration, callbacks/webhooks and transaction records
Inventory	Displayed values/history	Transactional stock changes with audit history
Commission	Displayed calculations	Server-side calculation and immutable order/ledger records
Payouts	Request/review screens	Eligibility rules, approval records and provider/manual settlement process
Notifications	UI states/content references	Triggered email/service notifications
Security	Not evaluated by a static prototype	Permissions, validation, CSRF/session protection, secure secrets and infrastructure controls
Performance	Static page speed only	Application/database/query/media performance under real load

Critical distinction

The prototype should not be presented as a functioning marketplace backend. It is the approved behavioral and visual specification that engineering will implement with real data, permissions, integrations and business logic.

How this prototype becomes the final product

Stage 1 — Prototype validation

- Client reviews the complete prototype and this guide.
- Core journeys, screen structure, terminology and business rules are confirmed.
- Required changes are consolidated into one revision list.
- Anything materially outside the agreed Phase 1 scope is separated as a later-phase item or change request.

Stage 2 — Development foundation

- Create the production application, environments and database structure.
- Implement secure customer, seller and administrator authentication and authorization.
- Build the shared design-system components represented in the prototype.
- Set up catalogue, seller, order, inventory and financial domain models.

Stage 3 — Functional implementation

- Connect the customer storefront to live catalogue, cart, checkout and account data.
- Connect the seller portal to seller-specific store, product, inventory, order and earning data.
- Connect the admin portal to marketplace-wide approvals, controls and reporting.
- Implement payment, commission, payout and notification workflows according to the approved rules.

Stage 4 — QA, UAT and production release

- Functional QA for each module and each role.
- Permission and cross-seller isolation testing.
- Responsive/browser testing against the prototype references.
- Payment and failure-path testing in sandbox/test mode.
- Client User Acceptance Testing (UAT) against the approved journeys.
- Production deployment, domain configuration, monitoring and backup setup.

How to use the prototype for scope control

A prototype is useful commercially because it creates a visible baseline. It allows both client and development team to distinguish a correction to the agreed product from a genuinely new feature.

Request type	Example	How it should be handled
Prototype correction	A button is mislabeled or a required field shown in the approved flow is missing.	Correct within the agreed prototype/revision cycle.
Implementation detail	Validation rules, database indexing, secure session handling.	Handled during engineering without redesigning the product.
Business-rule clarification	Seller earnings become available after delivery rather than immediately after payment.	Confirm before implementation because it changes workflow logic.
New feature	Wishlist, reviews, coupons, live chat, mobile app or advanced promotion engine.	Treat as later phase/change request unless already included in the signed scope.
Visual preference	Minor spacing, icon or color adjustment that does not alter flow.	Consolidate and apply during UI polish where practical.

Client approval checklist

The following items should be confirmed before the development baseline is considered frozen.

- ☐ The overall three-role marketplace model is correct: Customer, Seller and Admin.
- ☐ The customer journey from product discovery to order tracking is correct.
- ☐ The seller journey from application to payout is correct.
- ☐ The admin responsibilities and controls are correct.
- ☐ Seller approval/rejection states and requirements are agreed.
- ☐ Product publishing/moderation rules are agreed.
- ☐ Required product fields, images, pricing and variant rules are agreed.
- ☐ Inventory and cancellation/restoration behavior are agreed.
- ☐ Order statuses and allowed status transitions are agreed.
- ☐ Commission calculation policy is agreed.
- ☐ Seller earning availability and payout workflow are agreed.
- ☐ Refund/cancellation responsibility is agreed.
- ☐ Required payment methods for Phase 1 are agreed.
- ☐ Required shipping/tracking behavior for Phase 1 is agreed.
- ☐ Customer, seller and admin terminology is approved.
- ☐ Desktop and mobile presentation direction is approved.
- ☐ Branding and core design-system direction are approved.
- ☐ Any requested functionality not shown in the prototype has been explicitly categorized as Phase 1 or later.

Recommended feedback format

For efficient revision, feedback should identify the prototype page, the exact screen/section, the requested change and the business reason. This prevents contradictory comments and makes it easier to separate required corrections from future enhancements.

Field	Example
Prototype page	Seller Portal
Screen / section	Product Create → Pricing
Current behavior	Single base price and optional compare-at price
Requested change	Add wholesale price field
Reason	Required for a confirmed Phase 1 B2B pricing workflow
Priority	Must have / Should have / Later phase

Feedback that is most useful

- Missing business rules or actions.
- Incorrect terminology or status names.
- Data fields required for real operations.
- Role/permission issues.
- Workflow order problems.
- Mobile usability concerns.
- Items that must be added before development starts.

Feedback that should be consolidated

- Small visual preferences such as icon choice, isolated spacing or wording alternatives.
- Several comments that describe the same underlying requirement.
- Future feature ideas that are not required for the Phase 1 operating model.

What 'ready for development' means

The prototype is ready to become the production baseline when the client can review the major journeys without encountering unresolved structural questions. Minor visual polish can continue during development, but core workflow and business-rule changes become progressively more expensive once database structures and integrations are implemented.

Ready-for-development threshold

The client does not need to approve every pixel. The important approval is that the right users can perform the right tasks, in the right order, with the right information and business rules.

Practical readiness criteria

- No missing Phase 1 user role or core journey.
- No unresolved seller/product/order/commission/payout policy that changes system behavior.
- No major navigation or information-architecture changes outstanding.
- Required fields and statuses are sufficiently defined for database and validation work.
- Client agrees which items are Phase 1 and which are explicitly deferred.
- Prototype can be used by QA/UAT as the expected user-experience reference.

Recommended next steps

33. Share the Vercel prototype link and this document with all decision-makers.
34. Review the prototype role by role using the journeys in Sections 3–6.
35. Collect one consolidated feedback list using the format in Section 13.
36. Update the prototype only where the feedback changes an approved Phase 1 requirement or materially improves usability.
37. Obtain written approval of the product baseline and the Phase 1 inclusion/exclusion decisions.
38. Begin production development using the approved prototype as the visual/interaction reference and the approved development document as the technical/commercial reference.
39. Run milestone demos against the same journeys so progress can be measured against an agreed baseline rather than subjective expectations.

Recommended sign-off wording

Approved as the Phase 1 product and UX baseline, subject to the consolidated changes explicitly listed in the final review notes. Technical implementation details remain governed by the approved development scope and architecture document.

APPENDIX A

Prototype page index

File / route	Purpose
index.html	Overview and entry point to the prototype package
customer-storefront.html	Customer shopping, checkout, account and order-tracking experience
seller-portal.html	Seller onboarding, store management, products, inventory, orders, earnings and payouts
admin-portal.html	Platform administration, approvals, orders, financial controls and settings
responsive.html	Responsive patterns and mobile/desktop adaptation reference
design-system.html	Shared UI tokens, components, states and interaction patterns
consistency-review.html	Cross-context consistency checks and development-handoff reference

Prototype navigation

All seven pages are internally linked through the Prototype Navigation header. This allows a reviewer to move between product areas while keeping the review context visible.

Deployment note

The prototype package is prepared as a static Vercel-compatible site. The deployed URL can be shared together with this guide for stakeholder review. The static deployment is for design/product validation and should not be interpreted as the production application environment.

APPENDIX B

Terminology

Term	Meaning in this document
Prototype	Interactive visual representation used to validate product behavior and experience before full implementation.
Customer storefront	Public shopping experience and buyer account area.
Seller portal	Authenticated workspace used by a marketplace seller.
Admin portal	Authenticated control area used by the Veritas platform team.
Phase 1	The agreed first production release focused on the core marketplace operating model.
Commission	The platform's agreed share of a sale, calculated according to the approved marketplace rule.
Seller earning	The seller's recorded amount after the applicable platform deductions.
Payout	Settlement of eligible seller earnings according to the approved process.
UAT	User Acceptance Testing performed by the client against agreed requirements and journeys.
Production	The live, secure, database-backed marketplace used by real users.

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